

Slim and slick

Designed to look like a slick folder, it opens up to show you two very innovative things: a foldable and flip-display touch screen on one side and a big A4-sized notepad on the other. This notepad is powered independently and lets you take notes as if on regular paper with a special pen provided.

IBM TransNote



SPECIFICATIONS:
Pentium III 600 MHz processor, 64 MB RAM, 10 GB HDD, integrated 10/100 Ethernet, 56K modem, 10.4 inch TFT Touch screen

verdict

B +

IBM TransNote

Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Feature rich
- Small screen
Price: Rs 2,30,000
Contact: IBM India
Phone: 080-2079999
E-mail: isawkar@in.ibm.com
Web site: www.ibm.com/in

Restores in a jiffy

This card allocates 370-MB buffer space, which contains an image of the entire hard disk. The image is accessible only when you restart the PC and press the restore key, which can be password protected. It's completely independent of the size of the hard disk and protects the hard drive from viruses and destructive changes in software configuration.

Turbo Protect Card



SPECIFICATIONS:
Allocates 370 MB of buffer space
OS support: DOS/Win 3.1/98/NT/2000
Benchmarks:
8-10 seconds to restore lost data and partitions

verdict

B +

Turbo Protect Card

Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Fast restore
+ Password-protected restore key
- Bit difficult to understand
Price: Rs 4,450 (+ Rs 250 for installation)
Contact: Turbo Tech
Phone: 022-5705744 **Fax:** 022-5705755
E-mail: info@turbotech.com
Web site: www.turbotech.com

Fast reader

This 56x card performed well in all the tests. The amount of time it took to rip 25-MB tracks (first, middle and last track) from an audio CD to MP3 format was impressive. Though it didn't come with any bundled software or manual, at the present price level, it's worth a closer look and is a good buy for the home PC.

APEX CD-ROM 56x drive



SPECIFICATIONS:
Interface: IDE
Features: 56x read speed, digital and analog out
Benchmarks:
2328 overall score in SiSoft Sandra 2001, 3.3 MBps sequential read speed, 757 KBps random read speed 1940 in CD-Winmark 19 seconds to rip 25 MB tracks from audio CD to MP3 from the first track, 35 seconds to rip from the middle track, 43 seconds to rip from last track

verdict

B +

APEX CD-ROM 56x

Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Very cheap
+ Fast ripping time
- No bundled driver or manual
- No play button
Price: Rs 2,000
Contact: Apex Computer
Phone: 080-8368483

Not a star performer

The board couldn't go beyond 69 fps in *Quake III*. You should download the four-in-one driver from the VIA site, as the one bundled with the board does no good to its performance. Though reasonably priced, it still doesn't offer the juice that you can get from other boards in the same category. Definitely not suitable for gamers and graphics application users.

BIOSTAR Motherboard M6VCF



SPECIFICATIONS:
VIA 82C964X north bridge chipset, two PCI slots, 4x AGP slot
Benchmarks:
69 fps in *Quake III*, 26.1 fps in MBTR at 640x480 resolution at 32-bit depth, 23963 drive index in SiSoft Sandra 2001, 36 MBps sequential read speed, 8 MBps random read speed, 24.6 in Content Creation Winston 2000

verdict

B

BIOSTAR Motherboard M6VCF

Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Gave data transfer performance
+ Poor graphics performers
- Only two PCI slots
Price: Rs 4,500
Contact: BMI Technologies Pvt Ltd
Phone: 080-5582359
Fax: 080-5582207
E-mail: harishkr@postmark.net